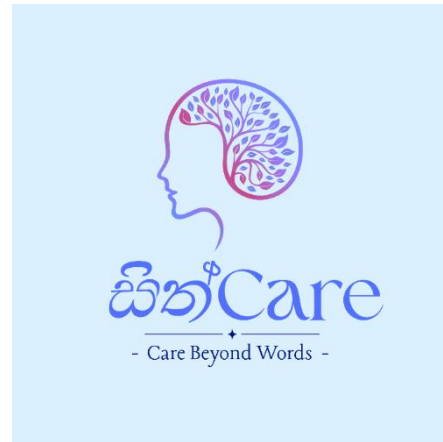




SENG 31242 – System Design Project

Persona 02

Interview Transcript

SithCare Channelling App

Group 10



Interview Transcript of Mental Health Patients – SithCare Channeling App

Date of Interview: 23/05/2026 (Saturday)

Location: Conducted remotely via Zoom

Interviewer: Project Member, SithCare Chanelling App

Interviewee: Persona 2, a 24-year-old, working while pursuing a diploma as a part-time

Interview Objective: To explore mental health patients' experiences and requirements for improved digital support.

Consent: The interviewee has consented to the interview being recorded and transcribed for internal documentation.

Source Link: [Persona 02 Interview](#)

Opening Statement

“Thank you for participating. We are developing a mental health support application to improve accessibility and support for patients. Your responses are confidential and will only be used for academic purposes. You may skip any question or stop at any point if uncomfortable. There are no right or wrong answers; we simply want to understand your experience.”

Section 1: Background Information (Ice Breaker)

Q1. Could you tell us a little about yourself? (Age range, occupation/student status, and anything you'd like to share about your lifestyle.)

Purpose: *Understand demographics and routines.*

Answer: I am 24 years old and currently working while also pursuing a part-time diploma. My lifestyle mainly revolves around balancing work and studies. I work five days a week and attend lectures on Sundays. I usually go to work early in the morning and complete a 9-hour shift. After returning to my boarding place around 7 PM, I have dinner and study if I am not too tired.

I also spend time on hobbies such as watching movies and listening to music. One important habit in my daily routine is writing a diary, which has helped me significantly over the years. Another thing that helps me is listening to ASMR before sleeping, as it helps me fall asleep. Even on weekends, I continue writing my diary and listening to ASMR.

Q2. Are you comfortable sharing your mental health diagnosis or concerns?

(Follow-up)



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- When were you diagnosed?
- How did you realise something was wrong?
- Who diagnosed you?

Purpose: Understand conditions.

Answer: This happened around 7–8 years ago when I was preparing for my O/L examinations. That period was extremely difficult for me. I did not realize something was wrong at first; my mother noticed changes in my behavior. I was not eating properly, could not study, struggled with staying up to study, and my overall health changed.

My mother suggested I talk to someone, and I consulted one of her friends, who is a doctor. I explained what I was experiencing. At that time, I was under extreme stress due to financial concerns surrounding my IGCSE examinations. I was afraid of failing and wasting my parents' money, which caused me to stop studying entirely.

The doctor explained that I was bottling things up and not expressing my emotions. I believe I was also experiencing anxiety. Although she was an anesthesiologist and not a psychiatrist, she guided my family and me through the situation. Her husband was a psychiatrist.

Q3. What symptoms or struggles do you experience because of your condition?

Answer: At that time, I experienced sleeping disorders and struggled to sleep properly. I also had digestive issues related to stress. I was not diagnosed with insomnia, but I had symptoms where I could not sleep.

I experienced low motivation and stopped doing many activities. I felt physically weak and often wanted to stay in bed all day. I isolated myself from others and overthought constantly, especially worrying about failing my exams.

Section 2: Current Mental Healthcare Experience

Q4. Can you describe your experience seeking mental health support?

Answer: In my case, seeking support was easier because my mother's friend was a doctor, and I could communicate with her over the phone even though we lived in different cities.

However, if I did not have that connection, I think seeking help would have been difficult. Many people may feel embarrassed or shy about consulting a mental health professional, especially if they do not have access to supportive networks.



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Q5. What challenges do you face when booking appointments? (based on personal experience)

Answer: The biggest challenge is choosing the right professional. When searching online, there are many options, and it becomes difficult to know who is trustworthy, suitable, or even legitimate. I think people need clearer guidance or filtering systems to identify the right specialist, especially for someone seeking help for the first time.

Q6. Have you ever delayed seeking help? Why?

Answer: Yes. I delayed seeking help because I was not ready to express what I was going through. I preferred bottling up my emotions and staying silent instead of opening up. Not expressing myself delayed me from getting support.

Q7. How comfortable are you discussing mental health openly?

Answer: I do not usually discuss my mental health with my family, including my parents and siblings. I also rarely talk about it with friends.

Sometimes, if things become too overwhelming, I speak to colleagues. In those moments, I may have emotional breakdowns, cry, and finally express everything I have been holding inside. Releasing those emotions has helped me.

Writing a diary has also been one of my biggest coping methods throughout the years.

Section 03: Technology Usage & Digital Behavior

Q8. Do you currently use any apps/websites related to mental health?

(Follow Up) What do you like/dislike about them?

Answer: One type I listen to frequently is ear-cleaning ASMR, which helps me sleep.

This has been one of the most effective healing methods for me because it improves my sleep and helps with insomnia.

What I like about it is that it is easily accessible and simple to find online. What I dislike is advertisements interrupting the content.

Q9. What frustrates you about existing healthcare or appointment systems? (Any improvements?)



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Answer: I think these healthcare systems are not marketed or promoted well enough, so many people are unaware of them.

Another frustration is not knowing which option or specialist is the right one to choose. More awareness and clearer guidance would help.

Q10. If a mental health app existed, what would make you trust it?

Answer: I would trust an app if it included: Reviews and recommendations from people with similar experiences, Privacy and security protection, verified doctors and professionals, and Positive feedback from users who benefited from the service. Recommendations from others would strongly influence my trust.

Section 4: Therapist Matching (Aimed at therapist rec. Qs.)

Q11. When looking for a therapist, what information matters most?

Answer: The things that matter most to me are Gender, Language, Privacy and confidentiality, Specialization and experience, being non-judgmental, and whether I can communicate easily and comfortably with the therapist. I would prefer someone I can speak to freely without feeling like I am burdening them.

Q12. What questions should an app ask before recommending a therapist?

Answer: I think an app should ask: Budget or affordability, Session preference (online or physical), Previous healing methods or coping mechanisms used, financial concerns regarding treatment, and Personal preferences regarding therapy. Understanding previous coping methods may help therapists provide more suitable support.

Section 5: Emergency & Crisis Situations

Q13. Have you experienced a mental health crisis? Only if comfortable

Answer: Yes. I once experienced a situation where things became overwhelming, and I ran away from home. I collapsed far away from home and remember wanting someone to find me.

Q14. During emergencies, what support would help you most?



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Answer: Location sharing would help me the most. During emergencies, when no one is around, I would want trusted people to know where I am so they can find me and help me.

Q15. Would you use emergency same-day booking? Why?

Answer: I am not very familiar with this type of feature, but it sounds like a useful option. Having access to immediate support during urgent situations seems beneficial.

Section 6: Anonymous Community & Peer Support

Q16. Would anonymous support groups help you? Why?

Answer: Personally, anonymous support groups would not help me because I am not someone who opens up easily to strangers.

However, I think they could be useful for more extroverted people or those who feel more comfortable talking to unfamiliar individuals instead of close contacts.

Q17. What concerns would you have about anonymous communities?

Answer: My concerns would be Judgment from others, Privacy concerns, and feeling uncomfortable sharing personal experiences with strangers. These factors would make me hesitant to participate.

Section 7: Privacy & Security (As mental health data is sensitive)

Q18. What privacy concerns would stop you from using a mental health app?

Answer: I would worry about my personal information being exposed or accessed by others. Even in anonymous spaces, there is a possibility of people identifying one another. I would be concerned about privacy breaches involving personal details entered into the application.

Q19. Would anonymity encourage you to seek support earlier?

Answer: Yes, if I was completely certain that my information would remain private and my identity would not be exposed, anonymity would encourage me to seek support earlier.



Final Question (Ending)

Q20. Is there anything you wish healthcare providers or technology developers understood better about mental health patients?

Answer: I think many people avoid seeking help because they fear judgment and are not ready to admit they need support. People often bottle up emotions and wait for things to improve on their own.

There is still a strong stigma around discussing mental health. I believe healthcare providers and technology developers should approach people more gently and make it clear that seeking help is not a bad thing. Friendly outreach and reassurance could encourage more people to open up and seek support.

Closing Statement

“Thank you for sharing your experiences. Your insights will help us design a more accessible and supportive mental health application for people who may face similar challenges.”